sorted

Sorted before anyone knocks.

Style and voice guide

Version 2.1 · 5 October 2026

Straight up. A little cheeky. Always sorted.

Write and design for homeowners who have been burned by a tradie before. Give them one next step, the price in writing and the licence on show. Use the fewest words that leave them calm and certain.

> Version 2.1. Logo: Phil's thumbs-up house, now the b in "by". Voice, colour and type carried over from v1. Devices and asset designs are proposals.

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How we sound

We write like the tradie you'd recommend to your mum: turns up on time, gives a straight price, explains it, cleans up after.

Turn up on time. Lead with the point. The first line says what's happening or what to do.

Give a straight price. Plain numbers, GST included, and what could change them. No fine print.

Explain it. Use ordinary words, one question at a time. Translate trade-speak. Never make anyone feel silly.

Clean up after. Cut every word that isn't working. End with what happens next, or simply stop.

Keep a wink. Cheek belongs in headlines, empty states and the sorted moment. Never near money, safety or disputes.

How we distil

Write the next step in one sentence. Keep what the reader needs to decide. Cut the preamble, the apology and the sign-off. Stop when the job is clear.

Keep the facts that change a decision: the price inc. GST, the time, the trade's name and licence, and when the money moves. Say when the concierge is an AI. Never promise more than the price hold and dispute process back up.

Starting lengths

ELEMENT	AIM
Push notification	Under 60 characters. What happened, then what's next.
SMS	Under 160 characters, one message. The trade, the time, the next step.
Screen headline	2–6 words. The state, not the feature.
Button	1–3 words, verb first: Get a quote, Book it.
Quote line item	3–8 words. The part and the work, no codes.
Concierge message	One question, under 25 words. Choices where they help.
Social caption	30–70 words. One job, one price or one tip.

These are editing prompts, not quotas. Keep the facts that matter. Sometimes "Sorted." is the whole message.

Voice in practice

Illustrative rewrites. Names, prices and licence numbers are placeholders.

BEFORE	SORTED BY
Your service request has been received. A provider will be in contact shortly.	**Got it. Wasim will call by 4pm today.**
Additional charges may apply should further work be required.	**If the job changes, you approve the new price first.**
All our professionals are fully vetted, trusted experts.	**Licensed plumber. Licence 123456C, checked 2 Oct.**
Payment is held in escrow pending completion of works.	**We hold the $385. Wasim gets paid when you say it's done.**
Unfortunately, availability in your area is currently limited.	**Busy week. Earliest is Thu 8 Oct, 7:30am. Want it?**
Your service provider is en route to your property.	**Wasim's on his way. About 15 minutes.**

Three useful tones

Reassure: "We're holding the $385. Nothing's paid until you say it's done."

Nudge: "Rate the job? It takes 30 seconds."

Celebrate: "Sorted. Wasim's paid and the tap's gone quiet."

Cheek runs high in marketing headlines, lower in confirmations and empty states, and at zero for money, safety and disputes. There the facts carry the message. Safety copy comes word for word from the safety policy.

House style

Australian spelling: colour, organise, licence (noun), license (verb). Sentence case for headings, buttons and menus. Contractions, yes. Numerals in product copy: 3 trades, 2 days.

Prices include GST, said once per screen: $385 inc. GST. Show cents only when they aren't zero: $82.50. Never "from" on a firm quote. Dates and times read Tue 6 Oct, 9:30am. Suburbs by name.

Write "Sorted By" in sentences; the logo is lowercase. Never SortedBy or SORTED BY. When a headline finishes the phrase, the b stays lowercase: Sorted by Thursday. "We" is Sorted By, "you" is the customer, and trades go by their names. The concierge says it's an AI in its first message and never borrows a person's name.

SAY	NOT
Firm quote	Estimate, unless it is one
We're holding $385 until it's done	Escrow, pre-authorisation
Licensed plumber, licence 123456C	Vetted pro, trusted expert
Approve the change	Accept variation order
Trade, tradie, sparkie, chippie	Service provider, contractor
Sorted	Successfully completed

Skip "she'll be right", ocker costume, startup speak (seamless, hassle-free, "Uber for tradies") and fake urgency. Punch at call-out fees and ghosting, never at trades. One exclamation mark per screen at most, none in errors, money or safety. No emoji in product copy.

The final edit

Can they say what happens next? Is the price in writing, with GST? Is the licence on show? Would your mum get it on a phone in the sun? Can another word go? Does it sound like a good tradie on the phone?

Logo

Phil's thumbs-up house, drawn as one line, is the b in "by". The thumb says sorted. The house says it's your home we're looking after.





The b is the mark
The thumb is the ascender. The fist is the bowl.

Set on the type
The fist sits on the baseline and fills the x-height. The thumb rises above.

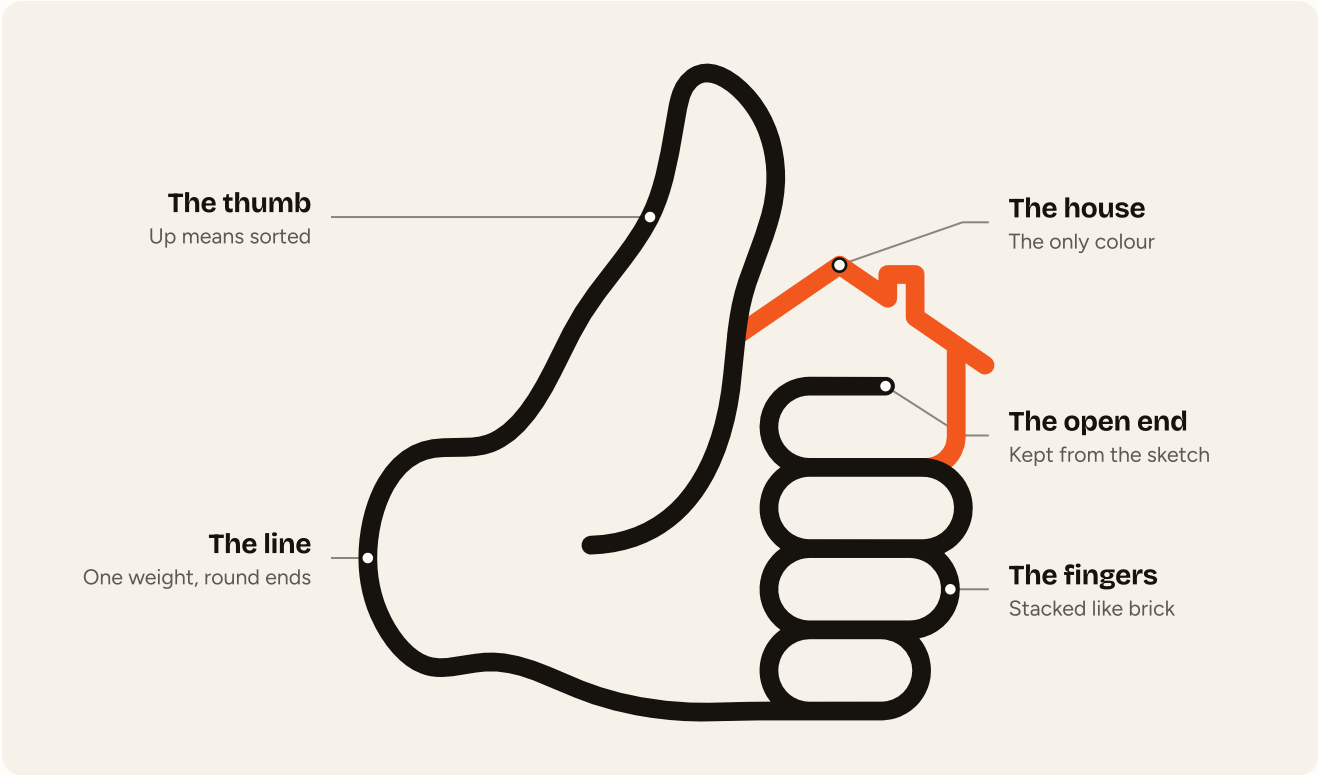
One line weight
Drawn to match the stems of Bricolage Regular.

One colour
Only the house is Spritz. Everything else is Ink.

The wordmark: "sorted by" in Bricolage Grotesque Regular, lowercase, with the mark as the b. Write Sorted By normally in prose.

The b is the mark. The thumb is the ascender and the fist is the bowl. The fist sits on the baseline and fills the x-height; the thumb rises above the line, the way a thumbs-up should.

One line, one weight. The line is drawn to match the stems of Bricolage Regular, with round ends. Only the house is Spritz.



On its own, the mark is the app icon, the avatar and the sorted moment.

The thumb. Up means sorted. It's the sign a good tradie gives from the ladder when the job's done.

The house. It sits on the fist in Spritz, the only colour in the mark. Its roof rises from the thumb and its wall drops into the first finger. Hand and home are one shape.

The fingers. Four, stacked like courses of brick: tidy, solid, sorted. The open end on the top finger keeps the hand-drawn feel.



Choose the version. The wordmark by default, on screens, signs and print. The mark alone for the app icon, avatar, favicon and the sorted moment. The tagline lockup for first hellos and campaigns.

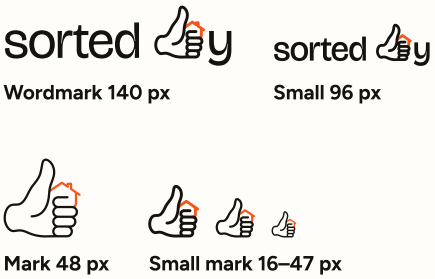
Get the colour right. Ink with a Spritz house on Plaster and Chalk. Plaster with a Spritz house on Ink and Charcoal. All Ink on Spritz or Brass. All Plaster on Gum. The app icon is the one exception: an Ink hand and a Chalk house on Spritz.

CLEAR SPACE



The height of the o in sorted, on every side

SMALLEST SIZES



Wordmark 140 px

Small 96 px

Mark 48 px

Small mark 16–47 px

Give it room. Clear space is the height of the o in sorted, on every side. Over photos, set it on a Plaster or Ink panel.

Start here. Wordmark 140 px wide (35 mm in print). From 96 to 139 px, the small wordmark: a heavier line, no chimney. Mark 48 px tall (12 mm); the small mark from 16 to 47 px.

Keep the line. Don’t stretch, tilt, outline, shadow or recolour it. Don’t fill the house, close the open finger or change the line weight. Never type a b beside the mark, or use the mark as a letter in other words. Place the file.

> The mark is agreed; the b wordmark is new in v2.1. The SVG files are the masters. The small versions and app icons are drawn for their size, not scaled down.

Typography

Give the headline a little character. Make everything else easy to read in the sun.

BRICOLAGE GROTESQUE · HEADLINES

Leaky tap? Sorted by Thursday.

ExtraBold **Bold** Regular wordmark only

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 $&?!%

FIGTREE · EVERYTHING YOU READ

Wasim's coming Thu 8 Oct, 7:30am. We're holding **$385 inc. GST** until you say it's done.

FIRM QUOTE · LICENCE 123456C

Regular **Medium** **SemiBold** **Bold**

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789 $&?!%

Two clear jobs

Bricolage Grotesque. Headlines, the total and the wordmark. ExtraBold and Bold, tight tracking, optical size on. Regular is kept for the wordmark. Aim for 2–6 words a headline.

Figtree. Everything people read: body, steps, quote lines, labels and fine print. Regular for reading, Medium for small print, SemiBold (650) for emphasis, Bold for buttons and capital labels.

Keep sentence case and natural spacing. Never squeeze or stretch letters to fit; cut words or split the screen first. Prices, times and licence numbers use tabular figures.

Starting settings

USE	STARTING SETTING
App display	Bricolage ExtraBold 40 px on 44, tracking −3%
Screen title	Bricolage Bold 32 px on 36
Section title	Bricolage Bold 26 px on 32
Total	Bricolage ExtraBold 32 px on 36, tabular, “inc. GST” beside it
Body	Figtree Regular 17 px on 26. Never smaller for reading.
Small print	Figtree Medium 15 px on 22
Label	Figtree Bold 14 px capitals, tracking +6%. Nothing smaller.
Social hook, 1080 × 1350	Bricolage ExtraBold 96–120 px, 1.05 line height
Social body, 1080 × 1350	Figtree Regular 44–48 px, 1.25 line height, 80 px margins

Keep the character scarce

One Bricolage headline per screen or card is enough. Keep conditions, dates and licence numbers in Figtree; the total is the one number in Bricolage. On phones, display sizes stop at 40 px.

Both families are free on Google Fonts under the Open Font License. Where they can’t be installed (Word, Outlook, email), use Arial Bold for headlines and Arial for text. The wordmark is outlined in the logo files; never retype it.

Colour

Warm Plaster stays dominant. Ink does the reading. Spritz marks the house and the next step.

Spritz

The house and the next action

HEX	#F2581E
RGB	242 88 30
CMYK	0 64 88 5

Brass

Waiting and money held

HEX	#DDB95E
RGB	221 185 94
CMYK	0 16 57 13

Ink

Reading text and the logo line

HEX	#16130F
RGB	22 19 15
CMYK	0 14 32 91

Charcoal

Dark surfaces

HEX	#2B2825
RGB	43 40 37
CMYK	0 7 14 83

Plaster

The page

HEX	#F6F1E9
RGB	246 241 233
CMYK	0 2 5 4

Chalk

Cards and sheets

HEX	#FFFDF9
RGB	255 253 249
CMYK	0 1 2 0

Gum

Done and verified

HEX	#1E6F64
RGB	30 111 100
CMYK	73 0 10 56

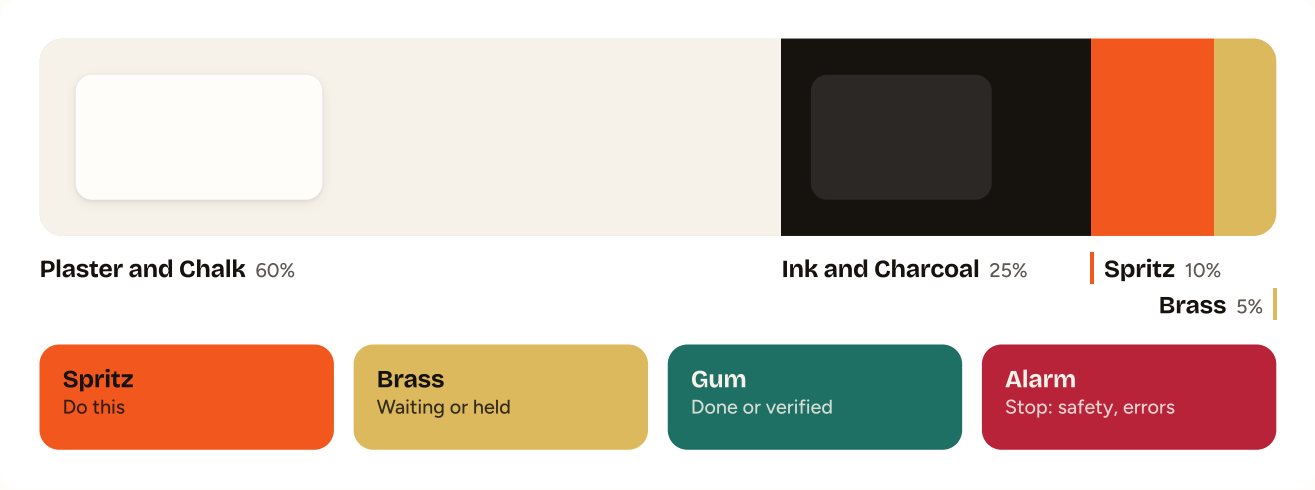
Alarm

Safety and errors only

HEX	#B8233A
RGB	184 35 58
CMYK	0 81 68 28

Colour means something. Spritz says do this. Brass says waiting or held. Gum says done. Alarm says stop. Each status also carries a word and an icon.

Keep the balance. About 60% Plaster and Chalk, 25% Ink and Charcoal, 10% Spritz, 5% Brass. Spritz is a highlighter, not wallpaper, except on full-bleed marketing panels.



Spritz never warns. Hazards use Alarm, so orange always means go ahead.

Ink on Plaster is 16.5:1 and Ink on Spritz 5.5:1. White on Spritz is 3.4:1, so buttons take Ink text. Spritz words on Plaster (3.0:1) only from 24 px; smaller orange words use Spritz text, #B5420F (5.0:1). Brass on Plaster (1.7:1) is never text. CMYK values are straight conversions; proof print work, match Spritz to a Pantone swatch on press and record the reference here.

Graphic devices

Four come from the mark; the docket carries every price. Use one per layout and keep the line weight as drawn.



sorted by ___. The wordmark finishes its own sentence: sorted by Thursday. Set the ending in Bricolage Bold at the wordmark's size, on its baseline, with a full stop. Spritz on light, Brass on dark, Ink on Spritz. Three words at most. A person's name only for a licensed trade who has the job.

The stack. The fingers become a progress tracker, one per stage from the bottom: firm price, booked, on the way, done. The roof goes on in Spritz when you confirm it's done and the trade is paid. Stages to come use grey-300, #C2BAAF. Always say the stage in words beside it.

The big thumb. The mark enlarged and cropped at a frame's edge, with the thumb and house in view. For social covers, banners and merch. Keep it clear of text and pair it with a headline, not a second logo.

The seal. A round stamp for promises we can back: firm price, licensed trade, paid when it's done. The ring text changes with the promise; the mark in the middle never does. Never under 160 px.

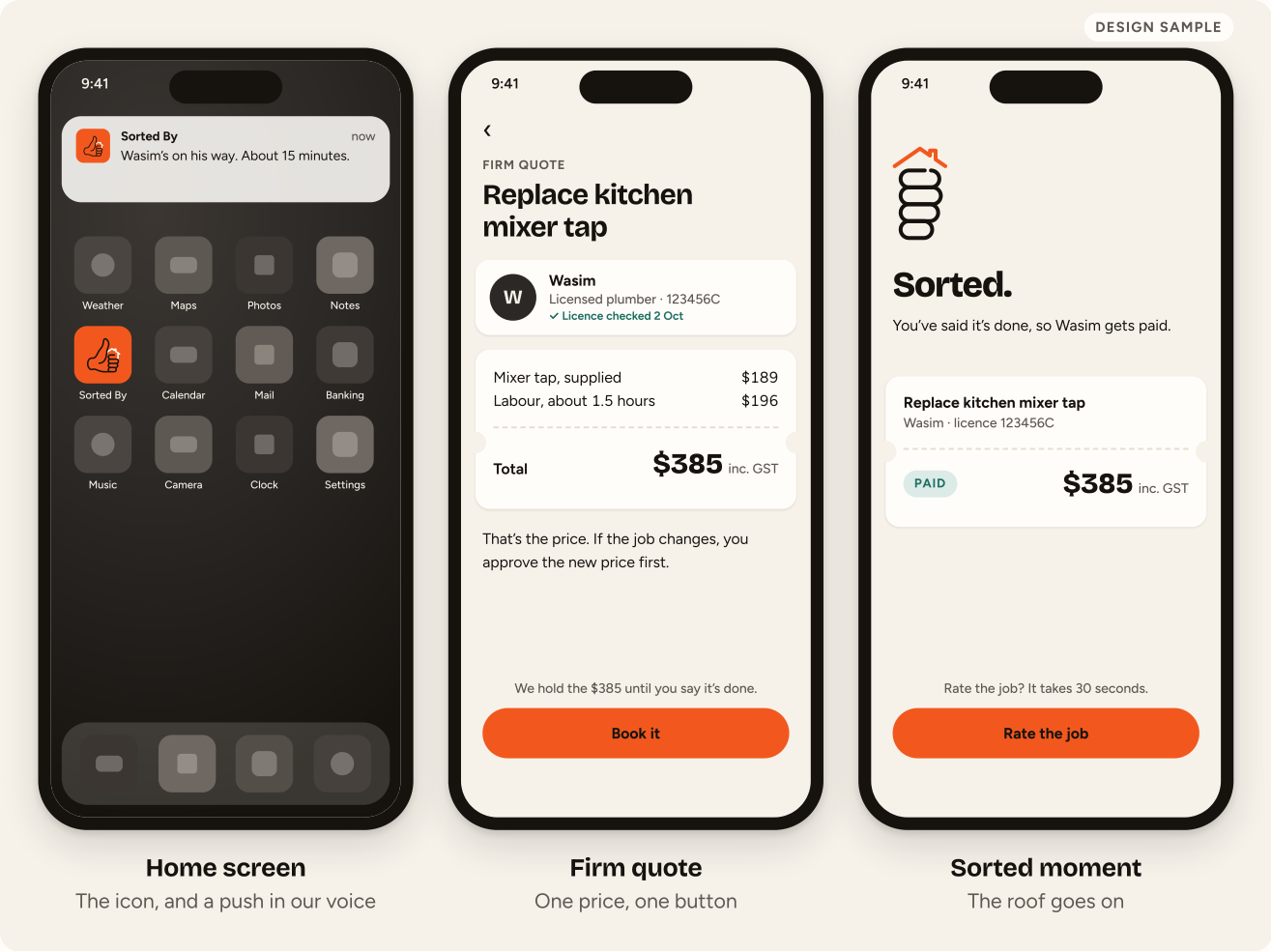
The docket. Every price sits on a docket: notched edges, a dashed tear, the total with inc. GST. Unchanged from v1.

> The devices are proposals redrawn from the new mark. Retired from v1: the block pattern and the Brass highlight. The icon set will be redrawn in the same line.

Brand assets

Design samples. Names, prices and licence numbers are placeholders until real copy and price-book prices are checked.

App



Home screen
The icon, and a push in our voice

Firm quote
One price, one button

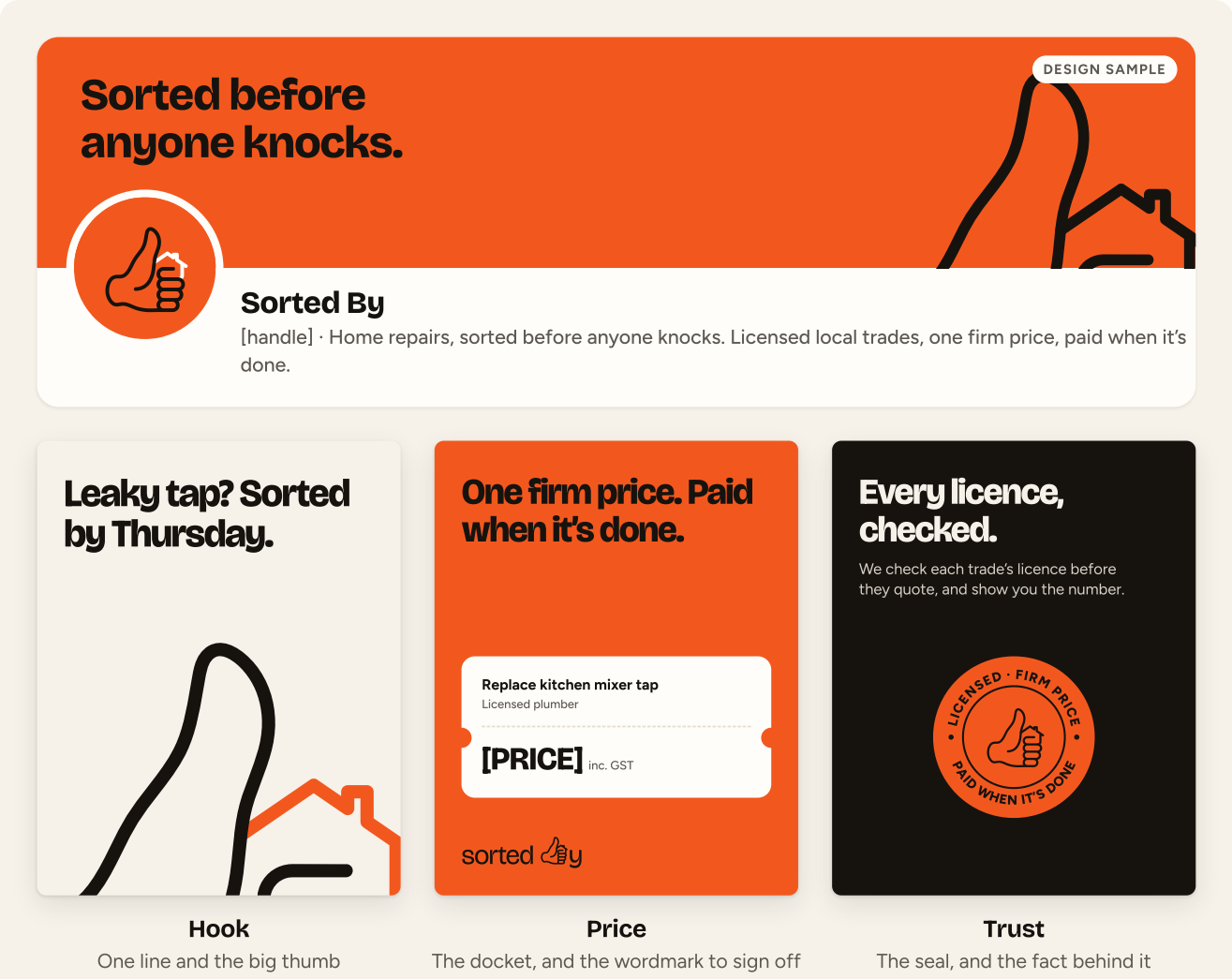
Sorted moment
The roof goes on

Home screen. The icon, and notifications in our voice: what happened, then what's next.

Firm quote. One price on its docket, the trade's licence on show, one Spritz button.

Sorted moment. The roof goes on, the money moves, and we say so in words.

Social



Hook
One line and the big thumb

Price
The docket, and the wordmark to sign off

Trust
The seal, and the fact behind it

Profile. The app icon as the avatar. A Spritz banner with the tagline and the big thumb.

Posts. One idea and one device per post: the big thumb, the docket or the seal. The avatar carries the logo, so most posts don't need it.

On site



Site sign
Spritz, all Ink, the trade and the licence

Vehicle magnet
Plaster panel, wordmark and tagline

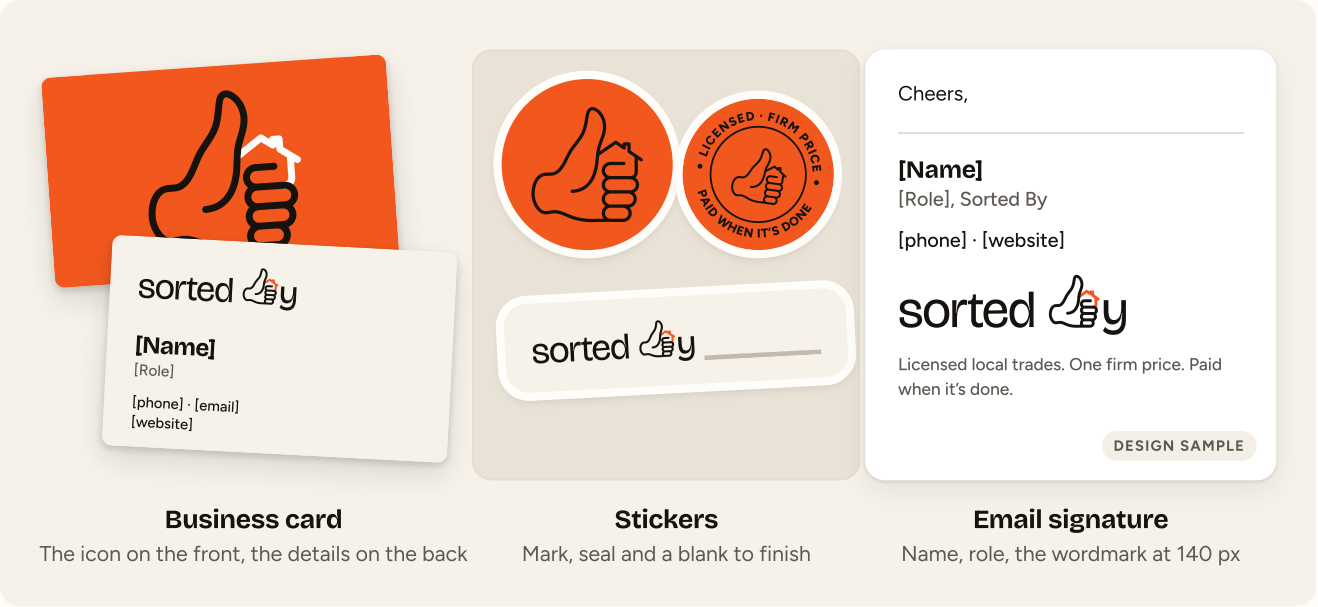
Hi-vis vest
The mark in Ink on the chest

Site sign. Spritz with everything in Ink: the wordmark ending in the trade's name, the licence number, the website. It has to read from the footpath.

Vehicle magnet. A Plaster panel with the tagline lockup. Keep it clear of door seams and handles.

Hi-vis. The mark in Ink on the chest, clear of the reflective tape. Use a compliant vest; the brand never changes its colour.

In hand



Business card
The icon on the front, the details on the back

Stickers
Mark, seal and a blank to finish

Email signature
Name, role, the wordmark at 140 px

Business card. The icon on the front, the details on the back.

Stickers. The mark, the seal, and a blank sorted by ___ to write on.

Email signature. Name, role, number, the wordmark at 140 px and one line of promise. Live text, not a picture of it.

Before it leaves the desk

Check it at 360 px wide and at arm's length. Check spelling, prices with GST, dates, licence numbers and alt text.

Keep the "Design sample" label until real names and prices are checked. Every promise must match what the price hold and dispute process back up.

Working files

The v2.1 pack (sortedby-v2.1-pack.zip) holds the SVG masters: the wordmark, small wordmark and tagline lockup in every colourway, the mark, small mark, app icons and the devices. PNGs cover the App Store, Android, web app, favicons and social avatars. The files are outlined, so no fonts are needed to use them; new endings for sorted by ___ need Bricolage Grotesque installed. Keep the originals as masters and work on copies.

FOLDER	WHAT'S IN IT
logo/svg	Wordmark, small wordmark and tagline lockup in each colourway; the mark and small mark; app icons and favicon
logo/png	Wordmark and tagline lockups at 2400 px; App Store, Android, web app, favicon and social avatar sizes
devices	sorted by ___ endings, the stack in every stage, the seals
guide-images	The twelve panels used in this guide

The Sorted By Identity canvas shows the logo beside Phil's sketch on its top row; the boards below still show route B, the earlier block logo. The Sorted By brand system holds the tokens and components, and shows the route B logo until it's updated.

Guide v2.1 replaces the v2.0 lockup (the mark beside the words) and v1's logo and devices; voice, colour and type carry over. Clear the name and logo with IP Australia before the brand goes public.



sorted

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